

The Whole World at War

World War II • 1939–1945 | Standards US.45, US.46, US.47, US.48, US.49, US.50, US.51, US.52, US.53, US.54, US.55, US.56, US.57, US.58

Name _____

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

World War II asked the United States to save democracy abroad — while it was still denying democracy to millions of its own people at home. Can a country fight for freedom in the world and against it at home, at the same time? And when winning the war meant building the most terrible weapon ever made — in Tennessee — what did victory finally cost?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

fascism	_____	isolationism	_____
	_____		_____
the Holocaust	_____	Double V	_____
	_____		_____
internment	_____	Rosie the Riveter	_____
	_____		_____
Manhattan Project	_____	United Nations	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the rise of fascism and totalitarianism in Europe, and how FDR moved a reluctant America from isolationism toward supporting the democracies. Notice: Picture a hundred thousand people packed into a stadium at night, torches blazing, every arm raised in perfect unison to one man on a distant... Debrief: Define fascism and give two examples of fascist or totalitarian regimes. Then explain why most Americans were isolationist, and how FDR moved the country toward helping the Allies before Pearl Harbor.	
2	Analyze the attack on Pearl Harbor and U.S. entry into the war, and identify the key Allied leaders and their roles. Notice: It's a sleepy Sunday morning. Sailors are still in their bunks, some at breakfast, the band tuning up for the flag-raising. And then the sky fills... Debrief: Explain what happened at Pearl Harbor and why it ended American isolationism. Then identify two Allied leaders and each one's role in the war.	
3	Analyze the major American military campaigns in the European and Pacific theaters — D-Day, Midway, and the island-hopping fight to Iwo Jima. Notice: You're nineteen, in a flat-bottomed boat crossing a freezing sea toward a beach you've never seen. The ramp drops. Ahead is open sand, then... Debrief: Describe the significance of D-Day and one Pacific campaign. Explain how the two-theater war led toward Allied victory, and give one detail that conveys its human cost.	
4	Analyze the Holocaust and the evolving U.S. response — from refusing Jewish refugees before the war to liberating the camps at its end. Notice: Before the shooting ever reached America, a ship full of desperate people sailed to within sight of the Florida coast — and was turned away. Nine... Debrief: Explain what the Holocaust was, and describe how the U.S. response evolved from before the war to its end. Why did Eisenhower order the camps documented?	
5	Analyze how Americans who faced discrimination at home — the Tuskegee Airmen and Black defense workers — fought for a 'Double V': victory abroad... Notice: Imagine risking your life for a country that makes you use a separate water fountain. You put on the uniform, you fly the missions, you bleed for... Debrief: Explain the 'Double V' campaign. Use the Tuskegee Airmen and Executive Order 8802 as examples of Black Americans fighting on two fronts. How did this experience connect to the later civil-rights movement?	
6	Analyze how the war transformed women's roles (Rosie the Riveter) and required total civilian mobilization (rationing, bonds, POW camps) on the... Notice: They told women their place was the kitchen — right up until the country needed them to build the bombers. Almost overnight, millions of women... Debrief: Explain two major ways the war changed the American home front, including women's roles. Why might the government have promoted images like 'Rosie the Riveter,' and what happened to many women workers after the war?	
7	Analyze the internment of Japanese Americans under Executive Order 9066 as a grave civil-liberties violation driven by prejudice, not security. Notice: You are an American citizen. You were born here, you pledge allegiance here, this is the only country you've ever known. Then one day the... Debrief: Explain what Executive Order 9066 did and why historians say it was based on prejudice, not security. Then explain how the story of the 442nd Regiment makes the injustice even clearer. Why does the government's later apology matter?	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
8	Analyze the Manhattan Project — including Oak Ridge, Tennessee — and the decision to drop the atomic bombs, weighing its justifications and its... Notice: A secret city rises in the Tennessee hills, so hidden it isn't on any map. Tens of thousands of people work there around the clock, most with no... Debrief: Explain what the Manhattan Project was and Tennessee's role in it. Then lay out the strongest argument FOR and AGAINST dropping the atomic bombs, and take your own position with evidence.	
9	Analyze the Yalta Conference and the tensions leading to the Cold War, and the founding of the United Nations as America's renewed commitment to... Notice: The war is finally ending, and three men sit for a photograph that will shape the next fifty years. They're supposed to be allies, planning the... Debrief: Explain what was decided at Yalta and how it helped lead to the Cold War. Then explain why the United Nations was founded and how it differed from the U.S. response after World War I. What is Tennessee's connection?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 6 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **SA troops march past Adolf Hitler at the 1935 Nazi Party rally in Nuremberg — mass spectacle designed to display totalitarian power.**

- Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
- Spark's question: *This is a 1935 Nazi rally at Nuremberg — tens of thousands marching in perfect formation past Hitler. Ask: the Nazis staged these events on...*
- What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1933	Fascism seizes power in Germany		
1941	Pearl Harbor brings the U.S. into the war		
1942	Executive Order 9066 interns Japanese Americans		
1944	D-Day opens the road to victory in Europe		
1945	The Double V and the seeds of civil rights		
1945	The atomic bomb ends the war		
1945	The United Nations is founded		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

World War II is the sharpest test yet of the 'more perfect union' question, because the contradiction is right on the surface: the United States...

Closing question: World War II showed the United States at its best and its worst at the very same time. Choose one example of the country fighting for freedom and one of it denying freedom, and argue what the war, on balance, did to the nation's founding promise. Then take a position on the hardest question in the unit: was the United States right to drop the atomic bombs? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:
